Environment / Disasters / Days

> **Priority A** | About **8%** of Current Affairs Common stems: Ramsar sites, environment rules, important days, and disaster awards.

What to note every time

Ask yourself	Why
What is the site, rule, or day?	Exact name
Where is it?	District and state
What is the date?	Notification date vs start date
Who runs it?	MoEFCC, NDMA, Coast Guard, and so on
Any theme?	Especially for international days

High-Yield 2025 carry cards (glacier / climate)

Yala Glacier tribute | 12 May 2025 | Langtang, Nepal

What happened Locals, Buddhist monks, and Himalayan glaciologists held a high-altitude tribute for **Yala Glacier** in **Langtang Valley, Nepal**. News desks often call it a glacier declared **'dead'** or joining the world's "dead glacier" list because of rapid melt.

Core facts

- Location: **Langtang**, northern Nepal (about **5,170–5,750 m**).
- Monitored by **ICIMOD** as one of the best-studied glaciers in the Hindu Kush Himalaya.
- Since the **1970s**, Yala has **shrunk by about 66%** and **retreated about 784 m**.
- Scientists warn it may disappear around the **2040s** if warming continues; the May **2025** event marked its critically endangered / "dead glacier" status in public messaging.
- Linked to the UN **International Year of Glaciers' Preservation 2025**.

> **Trap**

Do not pick Khumbu or Imja when the stem says the Nepal glacier marked 'dead' / tribute in **May 2025**. The name is **Yala**.

January 2026

New Ramsar sites in the news | late January 2026

What happened Just before World Wetlands Day, India publicly celebrated new wetlands of international importance under the **Ramsar Convention**.

Two sites highlighted together in the public announcement

1. **Patna Bird Sanctuary** — **Etah** district, **Uttar Pradesh** (Jalesar area).
2. **Chhari-Dhand** — **Kutch**, **Gujarat**.

About Patna Bird Sanctuary

- It is one of the **smallest** bird sanctuaries in Uttar Pradesh (about **1 square kilometre** / around **108 hectares** in detailed notes).
- Even though it is small, it hosts tens of thousands of birds in peak winter.
- It has marshes, woodland, and grassland, with farms around it.

About Chhari-Dhand

- It is a seasonal wetland in the desert region of Kutch.
- It is an important stop for birds entering India on the western route.

Count caution

- February notes often said India had about **98** Ramsar sites after Patna + Chhari-Dhand.
- Just preceding these in December 2025 were **Siliserh Lake** (**Alwar, Rajasthan**) and **Kopra Jalashay** (**Bilaspur, Chhattisgarh**).
- Later: Shekha Jheel = **99**; Surha Tal = **100**; Glaw Lake = **101**.
- With **100 Ramsar sites**, India ranks **1st in Asia** and **3rd Globally** (after the UK with 175 and Mexico with 144 sites).
- Full living table → Master tables. Do **not** treat Surha Tal as a January public headline; its big WED announcement was in **June**.

Solid Waste Management Rules, 2026 | notified 28 January 2026

What happened The Environment Ministry notified new **Solid Waste Management (SWM) Rules, 2026**. They replace the older **2016** Rules.

Core facts

- Notification date: **28 January 2026**.
- Full effect from: **1 April 2026**.
- Old rules replaced: **SWM Rules, 2016**.

> **Easy wrong options**

Mixing the notification date with the start date. Saying these rules replace plastic rules of another year.

Disaster award (cross link)

The Subhash Chandra Bose Aapda Prabandhan Puraskar 2026 is explained under Awards. Winners: **SSDMA** and Lt Col **Seeta Ashok Shelke**.

February 2026

International Workshop on Heatwaves 2026 | 11–12 February 2026 | New Delhi

What happened The **National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA)** hosted the **International Workshop on Heatwaves 2026** (preparedness, resilience, risk governance) on **11–12 February 2026** at **Sushma Swaraj Bhawan**, New Delhi (CoDRR series coverage).

Core facts

- Dates: **11–12 February 2026** (not 7–8 Jan, 30–31 Jan, or 20–21 Feb).
- Organiser: **NDMA**.
- Timing logic: before the March–June heat season so Heat Action Plans can be firmed up.

> **Trap**

Month–week traps are common. Lock **11–12 February 2026**.

World Wetlands Day | 2 February 2026

What happened Every year, **2 February** is World Wetlands Day. It marks the day the Ramsar Convention was adopted in **1971** at Ramsar in Iran.

2026 theme

- **Wetlands and traditional knowledge: Celebrating cultural heritage.**

Use this theme with the January Ramsar additions.

Budget environment points

- About **₹20,000 crore** over five years for **CCUS** (Carbon Capture, Utilization and Storage).
- Fisheries plan for **500 reservoirs and Amrit Sarovars**.
- More logistics and coastal cargo ideas are under Economy.

UP bird news

Uttar Pradesh reported a rise in the **sarus crane** count. Full card → UP Special. The sarus crane is the **state bird** of Uttar Pradesh.

March 2026

World Water Day | 22 March 2026

What happened Every year, **22 March** is **World Water Day**. It focuses on fresh water and why safe water matters for life and development.

2026 theme

- Theme: **Water and Gender**.
- Slogan often used: **Where water flows, equality grows**.
- The UN World Water Development Report 2026 title in coverage: **Water for all people: Equal rights and opportunities**.

International Women's Day | 8 March 2026

What happened 8 March is International Women's Day.

2026 UN theme

- **Rights. Justice. Action. For ALL Women and Girls.**

Plastic Waste Management (Amendment) Rules, 2026 | Notified 31 March 2026

What happened The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC) notified comprehensive amendments to the Plastic Waste Management Rules, 2016 under the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986.

Core facts - **Indian Standard Compliance**: All recycled plastic packaging must strictly comply with **IS 14534:2023** (*Plastics — Recycling and Marking of Products*). - **Feedstock Conversion is Recycling**: Converting plastic into chemical feedstock or new plastic polymers is now legally classified as **recycling**, not disposal. - **End-of-Life Disposal**: Broadened to formally include co-processing, waste-to-energy, waste-to-oil, and road construction. - **Mandatory Reusable Targets**: - **Rigid Plastic Packaging (0.9 to 4.9 L/kg)**: Reuse obligations escalate from **10% (in 2025–26)** to **25% (from 2028–29 onwards)**. - **Drinking Water Packaging ($\ge$4.9 L/kg)**: Reuse target rises from **70% to 85%**. - **Regulatory Entities**: Introduces formal definitions and liability for *Registered Environment Auditors*, *Plastic Waste Processors*, and *Sellers*.

April 2026

Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary | India's 99th Ramsar site | April 2026

What happened Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary in **Aligarh, Uttar Pradesh** was designated a **Ramsar site**. India moved to **99** wetlands of international importance. Uttar Pradesh's tally rose to **12**, keeping UP among the leading states.

Core facts

- Site: **Shekha Jheel** (also written Shekha / Sheikha in some older notes).
- District: **Aligarh**, Uttar Pradesh.
- India total after this tag: **99**.
- UP total after this tag: **12**.
- It lies on the **Central Asian Flyway** and hosts winter visitors such as the bar-headed goose and painted stork.
- The wetland complex grew beside the **Upper Ganges Canal** (built in the 1850s).
- It is also an Important Bird and Biodiversity Area (**IBA**).

> **UPPCS angle**

Pair this with January's **Patna Bird Sanctuary (Etah)** Ramsar. Surha Tal (Ballia) as India's **100th** came later (June) — do not push it into April.

Earth Day | 22 April 2026

- Theme: **Our Power, Our Planet**.
- Focus: everyday community action and renewable / climate choices.

Other April day themes

- **World Autism Awareness Day (2 April):** Autism and Humanity — Every Life Has Value.
- **World Heritage Day (18 April):** keep the year's ICOMOS theme only after locking an official note.
- **World Malaria Day (25 April):** Driven to End Malaria: Now We Can. Now We Must.
- **National Panchayati Raj Day: 24 April** every year (Constitution Day link for Panchayats is 24 April 1993).

India's first water-neutral railway depot

- Name: **Kankaria Coaching Depot**, **Ahmedabad**.
- Zone: **Western Railway**.
- Method highlighted: **phytoremediation** of wastewater.
- Water saving noted: about **1.60 lakh litres** a day.

May 2026

International Day for Biological Diversity | 22 May 2026

What happened 22 May is the International Day for Biological Diversity.

2026 theme

- **Acting locally for global impact.**

Saudi Arabia joins IBCA

Saudi Arabia became the **26th** member of the India-led **International Big Cat Alliance**. Full card → International.

Santa Marta fossil-fuel transition conference

First international conference on transitioning away from fossil fuels at **Santa Marta, Colombia**. Full card → International.

Soft Whitley Awards note

May conservation coverage named Indian / regional winners such as **Parveen Shaikh** and **Barkha Subba** for Whitley Awards work. Keep names only if a stem needs them.

June preview (do not mix into May mocks yet)

World Environment Day is **5 June**. Theme for 2026: **Inspired by Nature. For Climate. For Our Future.** Surha Tal as India's **100th** Ramsar sits in that June window.

June 2026

World Environment Day | 5 June 2026

What happened 5 June is World Environment Day, led globally by the **UN Environment Programme (UNEP)**.

2026 theme

- **Inspired by Nature. For Climate. For Our Future.**
- Focus: nature-based solutions, climate action, and protecting resources for the next generation.

Surha Tal | India's 100th Ramsar site | Ballia, UP

What happened On World Environment Day, India designated **Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary (Surha Tal)** in **Ballia, Uttar Pradesh** as its **100th Ramsar site**. Uttar Pradesh's tally rose to **13**.

Core facts

- Official name: **Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary**.
- Common name: **Surha Tal**.
- District: **Ballia**, Uttar Pradesh.
- India total: **100**.
- UP total: **13**.
- Freshwater wetland in the middle **Ganga** basin; formed from a Ganga meander.
- On the **Central Asian Flyway**.
- Bird richness: over **310** bird species; up to about **200,000** migratory birds in winter.
- Also supports the fishing cat and threatened fish such as **Wallago attu**.
- Global Ramsar sites: about **2,595**.
- India is highest in Asia and third in the world after the **UK** and **Mexico**.

Easy compare	Shekha Jheel	Surha Tal
District	**Aligarh**	**Ballia**
India count	**99**	**100**
UP count	**12**	**13**
Month news broke	April	June (WED)

> **Confused pair**

Shekha Jheel (Aligarh) = **99** / UP **12**. Surha Tal (Ballia) = **100** / UP **13**. Patna Bird Sanctuary is **Etah**.

UP CAMP (same WED window)

UP also launched the **UP Clean Air Management Project** (~**₹2,741 crore**; World Bank support; first **airshed-based** clean-air push in coverage). Full UP card → UP Special.

Other June environment days & health initiatives

- **12th International Day of Yoga (21 June 2026):**
- **Main Venue:** Red Road, **Kolkata, West Bengal**; attended by PM Narendra Modi (~35,000 participants).
- **2026 Theme:** ***"Yoga for Healthy Ageing"***.
- **Countdowns & Heritage Venues:** 100-day countdown at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi; 75-day at **Lonar** (Maharashtra); 50-day at **Kanha Shanti Vanam** (Hyderabad); 25-day at **Khajuraho Group of Monuments** (Madhya Pradesh).
- **Ladakh Single-Use Plastic Ban (19 June 2026):** Strict ban enforced against single-use plastics and open littering across the Union Territory of Ladakh to preserve fragile high-altitude Himalayan ecology.
- **World Day to Combat Desertification and Drought (17 June):** Rangelands — Recognize. Respect. Restore.
- **World Bicycle Day (3 June):** Cycling for a Greener Future (compilation theme).

IBCA Summit delay

First IBCA Summit planned for early June in Delhi was postponed. Details → International.

July 2026

International Tiger Day | 29 July 2026

What happened 29 July is International Tiger Day.

2026 theme

- **Securing the future of Tigers with Indigenous Peoples and Local Communities at the heart.**

Soft biodiversity repository note

Mizoram's **Natural History Museum** was notified as India's **21st Designated Repository** under the Biological Diversity Act, 2002. It sits in the Indo-Burma biodiversity hotspot.

Soft desertification follow-up

Keep June's Desertification Day theme ready if a July stem recycles rangelands language.

August 2026

Glaw Lake | Arunachal Pradesh | India's 101st Ramsar site

What happened Glaw Lake in **Arunachal Pradesh** became the state's **first** Ramsar site and India's **101st**.

Core facts

- Site: **Glaw Lake**.
- State: **Arunachal Pradesh** (first Ramsar).
- India total: **101**.
- Location setting: inside **Kamlang Tiger Reserve** and Wildlife Sanctuary (**Lohit** district in detailed notes).
- Type: freshwater lake in the **Eastern Himalayas**.
- Soft ecology: many tree and orchid species recorded in catchment coverage.

Step	Site	Place	India #
1	Shekha Jheel	Aligarh, UP	99
2	Surha Tal	Ballia, UP	100
3	**Glaw Lake**	Arunachal (Kamlang)	**101**

Full board → Master tables.

> **Ramsar chain 2026**

Shekha Jheel (UP, 99) → Surha Tal (UP, 100) → Glaw Lake (Arunachal, 101).

World Elephant Day | 12 August 2026

- Theme: **Bringing the world together to help elephants**.
- Linked award window: **Gaj Gaurav Awards** for elephant conservation (Environment Ministry).

National Space Day theme

- **23 August** — Towards Viksit Bharat: Innovating, Collaborating and Aspiring to Global Space Leadership.
- Full space card → Science / Defence.

Soft open ecosystems guide

First national guide to India's grasslands and open natural ecosystems launched at **UNCCD COP17**, **Ulaanbaatar**.

September 2026

World Ozone Day | 16 September 2026

What happened The world marked the International Day for the Preservation of the Ozone Layer.

What you should remember

- Date: **16 September** (Montreal Protocol signing anniversary, 1987).
- 2026 theme: **Global action for a cooler planet**.
- Extra line in the theme: celebrating **10 years** of sustainable cooling under the **Kigali Amendment**.
- Static link: Montreal Protocol (ozone) + Kigali Amendment (HFCs / cooling).

> **Trap**

Do not swap Ozone Day with Earth Day (22 Apr) or Biodiversity Day (22 May).

International Day of Peace | 21 September 2026

- Theme: **Invest in Peace — For Everyone, Everywhere, Every Day**.
- UN observance on **21 September** every year.

Environmental Policies, Wildlife & Conservation Landmarks (Ghatna Chakra Eye Drishti 2026)

Solid Waste Management (SWM) Rules, 2026

- **Statutory Authority**: Notified by MoEFCC under the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986; **supersedes SWM Rules, 2016**.
- **Mandatory 4-Way Waste Segregation**: 1. Wet waste (organic / kitchen) 2. Dry waste (recyclables) 3. **Sanitary waste** (sanitary napkins, diapers) 4. **Special care waste** (domestic hazardous fractions like fluorescent tubelights, waste batteries, electronics).
- **Stringent Regulations on Bulk Waste Generators**:
- Defined as any entity meeting any of: (i) floor area $\ge 20,000\text{ sq m}$, (ii) water consumption $\ge 40,000\text{ L/day}$, or (iii) solid waste generation $\ge 100\text{ kg/day}$.
- Must process organic waste on-site or procure an **Extended Bulk Waste Generator Responsibility (EBWGR)** certificate.
- **Tourism & Fragile Zones**: Local bodies in hilly and island regions are empowered for the first time to levy solid waste management and environmental conservation fees from tourists/visitors.

India's First Dugong Conservation Reserve (Tamil Nadu)

- **International Milestone**: Formally recognized by the **IUCN** at the World Conservation Congress 2025 in Abu Dhabi.
- **Location & Extent**: Located in the northern **Palk Bay, Tamil Nadu**; encompasses **448.34 sq km** including over **12,250 hectares of critical seagrass meadows**.
- **Species Profile**: Dugong (*Dugong dugon* / Sea Cow) is India's only strictly herbivorous marine mammal; listed as **"Vulnerable to Extinction"** on the IUCN Red List and protected under Schedule I of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.

Synchronous All India Elephant Estimation (SAIEE 2021–25) — First DNA-Based Census

- **Conducting Agency**: Wildlife Institute of India (WII) and Project Elephant under MoEFCC.
- **National Baseline**: Estimated total population of wild Asian elephants in India is **22,446** (Confidence Interval: 18,255 to 26,645).
- **State Rankings**:
- **#1 Karnataka**: **6,013 wild elephants** (highest in India).
- **#2 Assam**: **4,159 wild elephants**.
- **#3 Tamil Nadu**: **3,136 wild elephants**.
- **Kerala**: 2,785 wild elephants.
- **Uttarakhand**: 1,792 wild elephants (dominates the Shivalik & Gangetic Plains landscape).

Aravalli Hills Definition Committee (Supreme Court HPC)

- **Judicial Intervention**: On 3 June 2026, the Supreme Court stayed previous bureaucratic mining guidelines and constituted a 5-member High Powered Expert Committee (HPC).
- **Chairperson**: **Kanchan Devi**, Director General of the Indian Council of Forestry Research and Education (ICFRE).
- **Mandate**: Deliver a definitive, scientifically grounded definition of the "Aravalli Hills" and "Aravalli Range" across Delhi, Haryana, Rajasthan, and Gujarat to protect the fragile green wall from illegal mining.

Swachh Survekshan 2024–25 (9th Edition)

- **Ministry**: Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA).
- **Scale**: Assessed 4,589 urban local bodies, 58 cantonment boards, and 88 Ganga towns.
- **Central Theme**: **"Reduce, Reuse, and Recycle"**.
- **Key Innovations**: Introduced the **'Super Swachh League'** to evaluate consistent top performers and deployed Cleanliness Target Units (CTU) under *Swabhav Swachhata, Sanskar Swachhata*.

Tuvalu Joins IUCN as 90th State Member (October 2025)

- **International Accession**: The vulnerable Pacific island nation of **Tuvalu** formally acceded as the **90th State Member of the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN)**.
- **Geography & Biodiversity**: Encompasses 9 low-lying coral atolls / reef islands with merely 26 sq km of land, but stewards a massive **900,000 sq km Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ)** rich in pelagic marine biodiversity.

BIOFACH 2026 & Global Organic Agriculture Matrix

- **Honorary Title**: India was named **"Country of the Year"** at **BIOFACH 2026 (Nuremberg, Germany | 10–13 Feb 2026)**, the world's premier organic trade exhibition.
- **Nodal Agency & GI Rices**: Organized by **APEDA** (Ministry of Commerce & Industry), spotlighting five GI-tagged organic rice varieties: **Indrayani, Navara, Gobindbhog, Red rice, and Chak Hao (Black rice)**.
- **Global Organic Standings**:
- **#1 in Organic Land Area**: **Australia** leads the world (>53 million hectares).
- **#2 in Organic Land Area**: **India** holds the second-largest certified organic acreage globally.
- **#1 in Organic Producers**: **India ranks 1st globally in the sheer number of organic producers**.
- **Top Indian State**: **Madhya Pradesh** leads all Indian states in certified organic cultivation area.

India–FAO Blue Ports Initiative (September 2025)

- **Collaboration**: Joint initiative by the Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying and the UN Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO).
- **Investment**: ₹369.80 crore mobilized under PMMSY and FIDF to modernize coastal fishing harbors into climate-resilient, energy-efficient "Blue Ports".
- **Pilot Locations**: **Vanakbara (Diu)** and **Jakhau (Gujarat)**, alongside **Karaikal (Puducherry)**.

India's 100th & 99th Ramsar Sites (World Environment Day 2026 Milestone)

- **Historic Benchmark**: On **5 June 2026 (World Environment Day)**, India achieved the historic milestone of designating its **100th Ramsar site**.
- **100th Ramsar Site**: **Jai Prakash Narayan (Surha Tal) Bird Sanctuary**, located in **Ballia district, Uttar Pradesh**.
- Geographic profile: Freshwater wetland situated in the middle stretch of the Ganga River basin; critical sanctuary for migratory waterbirds.
- **99th Ramsar Site**: **Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary**, located in **Aligarh district, Uttar Pradesh** (notified as UP's 12th Ramsar site in Jan 2026 before Surha Tal became the 13th).
- Geographic profile: Freshwater lake situated 17 km from Aligarh; serves as an essential stopover along the **Central Asian Flyway (CAF)**; records 249 bird species (62 exclusively wetland-dependent).
- **National Ramsar Standings**:
- **Top State**: **Tamil Nadu** leads India with **20 Ramsar sites**.
- **Runner-up**: **Uttar Pradesh** ranks **#2 in India with 13 Ramsar sites**.
- **Largest Wetland under Ramsar in India**: **Sundarbans** (West Bengal).
- **Smallest Wetland under Ramsar in India**: **Renuka Wetland** (Himachal Pradesh).
- **First Wetlands in India (1981)**: **Chilika Lake** (Odisha) and **Keoladeo National Park** (Rajasthan).
- **Continental & Global Rank**: India ranks **1st in South Asia / Asia** and **3rd globally** in total Ramsar sites (behind UK: 175 and Mexico: 144).

#	UP Ramsar Site	District	Designated / Notified
1	Upper Ganga River (Brijghat to Narora stretch)	Bulandshahr / Hapur / Sambhal	8 November 2005
2	Nawabganj Bird Sanctuary (Shahid Chandra Shekhar Azad)	Unnao	19 September 2019
3	Sarsai Nawar Jheel	Etawah	19 September 2019
4	Samaspur Bird Sanctuary	Rae Bareli	3 October 2019
5	Sandi Bird Sanctuary	Hardoi	26 September 2019
6	Parvati Arga Bird Sanctuary	Gonda	2 December 2019

#	UP Ramsar Site	District	Designated / Notified
7	Saman Bird Sanctuary	Mainpuri	2 December 2019
8	Sur Sarovar (Keetham Lake)	Agra	21 August 2020
9	Haiderpur Wetland	Muzaffarnagar / Bijnor	13 April 2021
10	Bakhira Wildlife Sanctuary	Sant Kabir Nagar	29 June 2021
11	Patna Bird Sanctuary	Etah	4 December 2025
12	Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary (99th Ramsar Site of India)	Aligarh	19 January 2026
13	Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary / Surha Tal (100th Ramsar Site of India)	Ballia	Designated 5 June 2026

- **Recent Additions in Other States (2025–26)**:
- **Chhattisgarh's 1st Ramsar Site**: **Kopra Reservoir** (Bilaspur district; notified 12 December 2025).
- **Gujarat**: **Chhari Dhand** (Kutch; notified 16 June 2025).
- **Bihar**: **Gokul Reservoir**, **Udipur Lake**, and **Gogabil Lake** (all notified 13 May 2025; joining Kabartal, Nagi, and Nakati).
- **Rajasthan**: **Khichan Wetland** (19 Feb 2025), **Menar Wetland Complex** (19 Feb 2025), **Siliserh Lake** (7 July 2025).
- **Sikkim**: **Khachoedpalri Wetland** (15 July 2024).

Maitri II Research Station in Antarctica (East Antarctica)

- **Cabinet Approval**: Ministry of Finance approved the construction of **'Maitri II'** on **4 October 2025**.
- **Location & Target**: Proposed as India's **fourth research station in Antarctica**, located in **East Antarctica**; planned to be fully operational by **January 2029**.
- **Historical Timeline of Indian Antarctic Stations**: 1. **Dakshin Gangotri**: India's 1st base (established 1983–84; submerged under ice, operated for a few years). 2. **Maitri**: 2nd base (operational since **1989**); situated in the **Schirmacher Oasis** (a 20-km-long ice-free stretch at 50 m altitude, 100 km inland). 3. **Bharati**: 3rd base (operational since **2012** in the Larsemann Hills). 4. **Maitri II**: 4th base (to replace aging Maitri station by Jan 2029).
- **Executing Agency**: **National Centre for Polar and Ocean Research (NCPOR), Goa** (under Ministry of Earth Sciences - MoES).

India's First Bamboo-Based Ethanol Plant (NRL, Assam)

- **Inauguration**: Dedicated to the nation by PM Narendra Modi on **14 September 2025** at **Numaligarh Refinery Limited (NRL)** in **Golaghat district, Assam**.
- **Corporate Vehicle**: Established through **Assam Bio-Refinery Private Limited**, a joint venture between NRL and Finnish bio-technology leaders **Fortum and Chempolis Oy**.
- **Feedstock & Innovation**: Uses locally cultivated **bamboo** (non-food, fast-growing, high-lignocellulosic biomass) to produce 2G bio-ethanol, minimizing food-vs-fuel conflicts and driving green industrialization across Northeast India. (Foundation stone also laid for a modern polypropylene unit).

E85 Fuel Rollout in India & Ethanol Blending Milestones

- **Launch Date & Dignitary**: Launched on **World Environment Day (5 June 2026)** by Union Minister for Petroleum and Natural Gas **Hardeep Singh Puri** at an IndianOil retail outlet in New Delhi.
- **Composition & Specifications**: **E85** is a high-ethanol blended automotive fuel comprising **80% to 85% ethanol and 14% to 19% petrol**, tailored for **Flex-Fuel Vehicles (FFVs)**.
- **Flex-Fuel Vehicle Capabilities**: FFVs feature intelligent engine and fuel injection sensors that automatically detect ethanol-petrol blend ratios and can run seamlessly on blends from **E20, E85 up to E100**.
- **Phased Commercial Rollout**:
- Initial phase: 48 Public Sector OMC retail outlets across India.
- Near-term expansion: Scaled to **500 outlets by December 2026** and approximately **5,000 outlets by December 2027**.
- Long-term blending target: National aggregate ethanol blending to reach nearly **26% by 2030–31**.
- **Historic Blending Trajectory**:
- Blending rose from a meager **1.53% in 2014** to **20% as of 5 June 2026** — **achieving the national 20% blending target a full five years ahead of schedule**!

- **Economic & Ecological Benefits**:
- E85 is priced approximately **₹20 per litre lower than conventional petrol**, transferring domestic bio-refinery benefits to consumers.
- FFVs operating on E85 reduce lifecycle greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions by **around 61%** compared to conventional petrol vehicles.

India's First Green Methanol Production Plant (Kandla, Gujarat)

- **Location**: Developing at **Deendayal Port Authority (DPA)**, Kandla, Gujarat.
- **Scale**: 5 tonne-per-day green biomethanol production facility for cleaner marine bunkering fuel.
- **Partners**: Executed with **Thermax Energy** and **Ankur Scientific** (providing advanced biomass gasification technology).
- **Ecological Innovation**: Uses the invasive alien weed ***Prosopis juliflora*** (Vilayati Babul) biomass as its primary feedstock — converting an aggressive ecological hazard into clean green marine fuel.

Project Great Indian Bustard (GIB) — Captive Breeding Breakthrough

- **Status as of 14 June 2026**: Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav reported that the captive breeding programme added 3 more chicks, taking total hatched chicks in the 4th breeding year to **26** (18 via artificial insemination, 4 natural breeding, 4 wild-collected eggs).
- **Total Captive Population**: Captive stock reached **94 birds** at the breeding centre.
- **Species Profile**:
- Scientific Name: ***Ardeotis nigriceps*** (known locally as **Godawan**).
- State Bird of: **Rajasthan**.
- Conservation Status: **"Critically Endangered"** on IUCN Red List; listed under **Schedule I** of Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.
- Habitat: Flagship bird of dry grassland ecosystems; primarily concentrated in **Desert National Park (DNP), Jaisalmer, Rajasthan**.
- Historical decline: Over 1,000 individuals (1960s) $\to$ 745 (1978) $\to$ 600 (2001) $\to$ 300 (2008) $\to$ ~125 (2013).
- Ecological importance: Indicator of healthy grasslands; India supports 15–20% of the world's livestock on grasslands.

India's First Satellite-Tagged Ganges Soft-Shell Turtle

- **Release Event**: On **15 May 2026**, India's first satellite-tagged Ganges soft-shell turtle was released in the 1,302 sq km **Kaziranga National Park and Tiger Reserve in Assam**.
- **Species Profile**:
- Scientific Name: ***Nilssonia gangetica***.
- Protection: **Schedule I** under Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.
- Diagnostic feature: Differentiated from other riverine turtles by prominent **arrowhead-shaped markings** on top of its head.
- Ecological significance: Assam is a global freshwater turtle hotspot; of 8 soft-shell turtle species found in India, **5 species are found in the Kaziranga landscape**.

CMS COP15 — 15th Bonn Convention Conference (Campo Grande, Brazil)

- **Dates & Venue**: Held from **23 to 29 March 2026** in **Campo Grande, Brazil**.
- **Theme**: *"Connecting Nature to Sustain Life"*.
- **Parent Treaty**: Convention on the Conservation of Migratory Species of Wild Animals (**CMS** / **Bonn Convention**), signed in 1979 in Bonn, Germany, under UNEP auspices.
- **Major Outcomes**:
- Granted new or upgraded treaty protection to **40 species, subspecies, and populations** of migratory birds, aquatic wildlife, and terrestrial animals across CMS Appendices I and II.
- CMS now protects over **1,200 unique migratory species**.
- Final approval to 70 proposals, 15 appendix amendments, 16 Concerted Actions, and 39 resolutions.
- Targeted conservation measures approved for: **Cheetah, striped hyena, snowy owl, giant otter, great hammerhead shark**, and declining shorebirds.
- **Presidency & Future Venue**:
- **Brazil** assumed the CMS COP Presidency for the 2026–2029 triennium.
- **CMS COP16** will be held in **Bonn, Germany in 2029**, marking the **50th anniversary** of the Bonn Convention (1979–2029).

"Bhavasagara" — National Repository for Deep-Sea Fauna (Kochi, Kerala)

- **Notification**: Designated on **30 March 2026** by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC).
- **Host Institution**: **Centre for Marine Living Resources & Ecology (CMLRE)** in Kochi, Kerala (an attached institute under the **Ministry of Earth Sciences - MoES**).
- **Core Role**: Designated as India's **National Repository for Deep-Sea Fauna** from India's 2.37 million sq km Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ).
- **Holdings**: Houses over **3,560 taxonomically identified and geo-referenced voucher specimens**; serves as the official national custodian for type specimens of new deep-sea species discovered in Indian waters.

Project Him Sarovar (Ladakh Cold-Desert Water Security)

- **Launch Date**: Launched on **10 April 2026** by **Vinay Saxena, Lieutenant Governor of Ladakh**.
- **Focus**: Tailored for Ladakh's high-altitude cold-desert ecosystem; focuses on **scientific snow harvesting**, capturing glacial melt and seasonal snowmelt in small engineered water bodies to mitigate severe lean-season water shortages.
- **Targets**:
- Phase I: 50 water bodies planned (30 in Leh, 20 in Kargil) covering ~25% of Ladakh villages (5 already completed by June 2026).
- Target: Scale up to 100 such high-altitude water bodies by 2027.

India Withdraws Candidature to Host COP33 UNFCCC (2028)

- **Diplomatic Development**: India formally withdrew its bid to host **COP33**, the 33rd Conference of the Parties to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC), scheduled for **2028**.
- **Background**: PM Narendra Modi had formally proposed India as COP33 host at COP28 (Dubai, Dec 2023), reiterated at the BRICS Rio Summit in July 2025.
- **UN Regional Rotation**: Under the UN 5-regional-group system:
- **COP31 (2026)**: Co-hosted by **Türkiye and Australia** (Western European and Others Group - WEOG).
- **COP33 (2028)**: Allotted to the **African Group**; to be hosted in the capital of **Ethiopia** (Addis Ababa).

Project Cheetah — 9 Cheetahs Translocated from Botswana to Kuno NP

- **Translocation**: Arrival of **9 wild cheetahs from Botswana** at **Kuno National Park (Sheopur district, Madhya Pradesh)**, marking the third major international cheetah batch.
- **Historical Milestones**:
- Declared officially extinct in India in **1952**.
- Last confirmed sighting recorded in **1947 in Koriya district** (in erstwhile MP, now Chhattisgarh).
- **Project Cheetah** formally launched on **17 September 2022**.
- Batch 1: **8 cheetahs from Namibia** (released September 2022).
- Batch 2: **12 cheetahs from South Africa** (released February 2023).
- Batch 3: **9 cheetahs from Botswana** (2026).
- **Cub Births & Population Update (March–June 2026)**:
- Female cheetah **Jwala** (formerly **Siyaya**, Namibian cheetah brought in Sep 2022) gave birth to **5 healthy cubs** at Kuno on **9 March 2026** (her 3rd litter in India, 10th successful litter under the reintroduction project).
- Raised the total count of India-born cheetah cubs to **33**.
- **Translocation Flight**: The 9 Botswana cheetahs (6 females, 3 males) were donated from Mokolodi Nature Reserve during President Droupadi Murmu's state visit, airlifted by IAF from Gaborone to Gwalior, and ferried by helicopters to Kuno on **28 February 2026**.
- **Current Total Count (June 2026)**: Total cheetah population stands at **52** (**49 at Kuno National Park** and **3 at Gandhi Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary, MP**).
- Second Home: **Gandhi Sagar Wildlife Sanctuary (Mandsaur & Neemuch districts, MP)** operationalized as an additional habitat.

NHAI "Bee Corridors" Initiative (February 2026)

- **Launch Date**: **17 February 2026** by the National Highways Authority of India (**NHAI**).

- **Paradigm Shift**: Transitioning highway roadside greening from purely ornamental beautification to **ecological pollinator corridors**.
- **Execution**: Planting native pollinator-friendly flowering shrubs, nectar-yielding flora, and nesting micro-habitats along national highway medians and right-of-ways (expanding the Green Highways Policy 2015).

State of India's Environment (SOE) 2026 Report | CSE

- **Publisher**: **Centre for Science and Environment (CSE)** and *Down to Earth* magazine (released 25 February 2026 at the Anil Agarwal Dialogue 2026 in Nimli, Alwar, Rajasthan).
- **Extreme Weather Shocks**:
- 2025 witnessed the highest frequency and severity of extreme weather disasters in 4 years.
- Between 1 January and 30 November 2025, extreme weather events struck on **99% of days (332 out of 334 days)** in India, claiming 4,421 lives and devastating **17.41 million hectares of standing crop area**.
- Worst hit States: **Himachal Pradesh** (267 disaster days), **Kerala** (173 days), **Madhya Pradesh** (162 days).
- **Air Quality & Ocean Stress**:
- Only **15% of India's population (~200 million people)** resides within 10 km of a continuous ambient air quality monitoring station (CAAQMS); **85% (>1.2 billion people)** live outside reliable monitoring.
- Global ocean acidity has surged by **30% to 40%** since the industrial era.

India's 7th National Report (NR-7) to the Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD)

- **Submission**: Submitted by MoEFCC on **26 February 2026** (ahead of the 28 February statutory deadline under Article 26 of the CBD).
- **Framework**: Indicator-based assessment deploying **142 national indicators mapped across 23 National Biodiversity Targets (NBTs)**, aligned with the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework (KM-GBF).
- **Key National Baselines**:
- **Recorded Forest Area (RFA)**: **7,75,377 sq km** (of which 5,20,365 sq km is under actual forest cover; up by 1,445.81 sq km over 2021).
- **Wetland Extent**: Latest high-resolution NWIA/SARITA mapping estimates **3.58 million wetlands** covering **16.89 million hectares (5.12% of India's geographical area)** (up from 15.98M ha in Wetland Atlas 2017).
- **Agroforestry**: Covers **8.65% of total geographical area (28.42 million hectares)**.

MoEFCC Year-End Review 2025 — Wildlife & Environmental Milestones

- **Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam**: **262.4 crore saplings planted** as of 24 December 2025; digitally monitored on the **Meri LiFE portal**.
- **Project Tiger Milestone**:
- India expanded its network to **58 Tiger Reserves** covering ~85,000 sq km (up from 46 reserves in 2014).
- New Tiger Reserve Added: **Madhav Tiger Reserve (Shivpuri district, Madhya Pradesh)**.
- 6th cycle of All India Tiger Estimation initiated.
- **Project Elephant**:
- Elephant Reserves expanded to **33** (covering ~8,610 sq km additional protected habitat).
- **150 elephant corridors** formally ground-truthed across 15 states.
- Fatal conflict ex-gratia compensation enhanced: **Doubled from ₹5 lakh to ₹10 lakh**.
- Captive elephant DNA profiling instituted via the **Gaj Soochna App**.
- **International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA)**:
- Framework Agreement entered into legal force on **23 January 2025**; membership expanded to 18 nations for conserving 7 big cats (Tiger, Lion, Leopard, Snow Leopard, Cheetah, Jaguar, Puma).
- **National Board for Wildlife (NBWL)**: 7th meeting chaired by PM Modi at **Sasan, Gir (Gujarat)** on 3 March 2025.
- **National Clean Air Programme (NCAP)**:
- 130 non-attainment cities covered; ₹13,415 crore performance-linked funds disbursed.
- 103 cities achieved PM10 reductions compared to 2017–18; 64 cities reduced PM10 by >20%; 22 cities achieved NAAQS compliance.
- **Nagar Van & MISHTI Schemes**:
- **Nagar Van Yojana**: 620 urban forest projects sanctioned (₹654 crore outlay).

- **MISHTI (Mangrove Initiative for Shoreline Habitats & Tangible Incomes)**: 22,560 hectares of degraded mangrove ecosystems restored (4,536 ha restored in 2025 alone).
- **Blue Flag Beaches**: **18 beaches across 7 coastal States and 4 UTs** hold international Blue Flag certification.
- **India's Paris NDC Achievements**:
- Reduced GDP emission intensity by **36% from 2005 levels by 2020** (ahead of 45% by 2030 target).
- Non-fossil installed electric capacity surpassed **50% in June 2025** (ahead of 50% by 2030 target).
- Cumulative additional carbon sink reached **2.29 billion tonnes CO2e** (target: 2.5–3.0 billion tonnes by 2030).

30th Conference of the Parties to the UNFCCC (COP30 | Belém, Brazil)

- **Dates & Venue**: Held from **10 to 21 November 2025** in **Belém (Amazon region), Brazil**.
- **Core Theme & Architecture**: "Implementation-First" agenda centered on the **COP30 Global Climate Action Agenda (GCAA)** with 30 activation groups across 482 initiatives.
- **Key Outcomes — The Belém Package**:
- **Global Mutirão Decision**: Derived from the Brazilian indigenous term *"Mutirão"* (collective community action for shared benefit, identical to India's *"Shramdaan"*).
- **Climate Finance Mandate**: Strengthened interpretation of **Article 9.1 of the Paris Agreement** ("developed country Parties shall provide financial resources to developing country Parties"). Two-year Climate Finance Work Programme launched.
- **Tropical Forest Forever Facility (TFFF)**: Brazil-championed $125 billion blended finance facility paying countries performance-based returns for preserving tropical forest biomes.
- **Belém 4x Pledge**: Endorsed by 23 nations to **quadruple sustainable low-carbon fuel capacity by 2035** (green hydrogen, advanced second-generation biofuels, and e-fuels), tracked by the IEA.
- **Belém Health Action Plan**: World's first dedicated international climate adaptation plan for public health ($300 million initial mobilization).
- **India's Assertive Stance**:
- Firmly demanded **$1.3 trillion annually** in public grant-equivalent climate finance from developed nations under Article 9.1.
- Vehemently opposed unilateral carbon border measures like the EU's **CBAM (Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism)** as protectionist trade barriers violating Common But Differentiated Responsibilities (CBDR-RC).
- Next host: **COP31 (2026)** to be co-hosted by **Türkiye and Australia**.

Global Methane Status Report (Launched at COP30)

- **Published by**: UNEP and the Climate and Clean Air Coalition (CCAC).
- **Global Methane Pledge (GMP)**: Includes 159 signatory countries + European Commission, covering ~57% of global anthropogenic methane emissions.
- **Source Breakdown**: Anthropogenic methane originates from **Agriculture (42%)**, **Energy/Fossil Fuels (38%)**, and **Waste (20%)**.
- **Mitigation Potential**: G20+ countries generate 65% of global methane emissions and hold 72% of cost-effective abatement potential.

UNEP Emissions Gap Report 2025 (16th Edition: "Off Target")

- **Released on**: 4 November 2025 by the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP).
- **Emissions Peak**: Global anthropogenic greenhouse gas emissions reached a record **57.7 GtCO2e in 2024** (+2.3% surge over 2023).
- **Driver of Surge**: Net Land Use, Land-Use Change and Forestry (LULUCF) emissions spiked by ~21% in 2024 (accounting for 53% of the total emissions growth).
- **Temperature Projections**: Current policies lead to catastrophic global warming of **~2.8°C**; full implementation of unconditional NDCs leads to **~2.5°C**, and conditional NDCs to **~2.3°C** (far above the Paris Agreement's 1.5°C threshold).
- **Emissions Gap for 2030**: 12 GtCO2e gap remains for a 2°C pathway; 20 GtCO2e gap remains for 1.5°C.

FAO Global Forest Resources Assessment (GFRA) 2025

- **Publisher**: **Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)** of the United Nations (published quinquennially / every 5 years; covers 1990–2025).
- **Global Forest Envelope**: Earth's total forest area stands at **4.14 billion hectares** (~32% of global land mass).

- **Deforestation Deceleration**: Net annual forest loss decreased from 10.7 million ha/year in the 1990s to **4.12 million ha/year in 2015–2025**.
- **Forest Wealth Concentration**: Over 54% of global forests are concentrated in five mega-forest nations: **1. Russia, 2. Brazil, 3. Canada, 4. United States, 5. China**.
- **India's Global Standings**:
- **Total Forest Area**: India holds **72.7 million hectares (~2% of world's forest)**, advancing to **9th position globally** (overtaking previous 10th spot).
- **Annual Net Forest Gain**: India retained **3rd position worldwide** in average annual net forest area gain.
- **Carbon Sequestration**: India's forests rank **5th globally** among national forest carbon sinks, capturing an estimated **150 Mt of CO2 annually** (2021–2025).

Ramsar Convention COP15 (Victoria Falls, Zimbabwe)

- **Dates & Venue**: Held from **23 to 31 July 2025** in **Victoria Falls, Zimbabwe**.
- **Conference Theme**: *"Protecting Wetlands for Our Common Future"*.
- **Strategic Plan**: Adopted the **5th Strategic Plan (2025–2034)** featuring 4 systemic goals and 18 operational targets.
- **Accreditation of Indian Cities**: **Indore (Madhya Pradesh)** and **Udaipur (Rajasthan)** became India's **first-ever officially accredited "Wetland Cities"** under the international Wetland City Accreditation (WCA) scheme!
- **Historic Indian Resolution**: India tabled a landmark resolution titled *"Promoting Sustainable Lifestyles for the Wise Use of Wetlands"*, inspired by PM Modi's **Mission LiFE**, adopted unanimously by all 172 member states.
- **Next COP16**: Scheduled for **July 2028 in Panama City, Panama**.

Cold Desert Biosphere Reserve (Himachal Pradesh) Added to UNESCO WNBR

- **Global Recognition**: Included in **UNESCO's World Network of Biosphere Reserves (WNBR)** during the **5th World Congress of Biosphere Reserves (37th MAB ICC session) in Hangzhou, China**.
- **National Tally**: India now possesses **13 UNESCO MAB-recognized Biosphere Reserves** (out of 18 national Biosphere Reserves).
- **Geographic Extent**: Spans **7,770 sq km** across Spiti Valley (altitudes 3,300 m to 6,600 m); India's first high-altitude cold desert biosphere reserve in the UNESCO network.
- **Protected Areas Included**: Encompasses **Pin Valley National Park**, **Kibber Wildlife Sanctuary**, **Chandratal Wildlife Sanctuary/Wetland**, and Sarchu.

Sundarbans Tiger Reserve (STR) Becomes India's 2nd Largest Tiger Reserve

- **Sanction Date**: Approved by the National Board for Wildlife (NBWL) on **19 August 2025**.
- **Expansion Area**: Added **1,044.68 sq km** of contiguous mangrove forests (Matla, Raidighi, and Ramganga ranges of South 24 Parganas) to Sundarbans Tiger Reserve.
- **Total Area & National Rank**: Total area expanded to **2,584.89 sq km**, making STR the **2nd largest tiger reserve in India** (behind **Nagarjunsagar-Srisailam Tiger Reserve** in Andhra Pradesh at 3,296 sq km).

'Matri Van' Urban Forest Initiative (Gurugram, Haryana)

- **Launch**: Inaugurated on **2 August 2025** in **Gurugram** by Union Ministers Bhupender Yadav and Manohar Lal under the ***Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam*** campaign.
- **Scale & Ecological Remediation**: 750-acre thematic urban forest established in the Aravalli Hills along the Gurugram–Faridabad Road; eradicates invasive Kabuli Kikar (*Prosopis juliflora*) and re-establishes native Dhak and Amaltash forests across 10 specialized theme groves (Bodhi Vatika, Bambusetum, Aravalli Arboretum, Pushp Vatika, Sugandh Vatika, Nakshatra Vatika, etc.).

India's First Centre of Excellence for Hornbill Conservation (Tamil Nadu)

- **Location**: Established by Tamil Nadu Forest Department at **Anamalai Tiger Reserve (ATR)** in **Coimbatore district**.
- **Target Species**: Focused on the four indigenous hornbill species of the Western Ghats: **Great Hornbill**, **Malabar Grey Hornbill**, **Malabar Pied Hornbill**, and **Indian Grey Hornbill** (venerated as the "farmers of the forest" for vital canopy seed dispersal).

National Red List Roadmap and Vision 2025–2030

- **Unveiled at**: IUCN World Conservation Congress 2025 in Abu Dhabi by MoS Kirti Vardhan Singh.
- **Partners**: Jointly developed by MoEFCC, **Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)**, **Botanical Survey of India (BSI)**, and IUCN's Centre for Species Survival to create an authentic indigenous red-list threat registry for Indian flora and fauna.

Namo Oxygen Parks (New Delhi)

- **Inauguration**: On World Environment Day (**5 June 2026**), Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav and Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta inaugurated **18 Namo Oxygen Parks** across Delhi under the nationwide ***Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam*** campaign.
- **Context**: Created as a public ecological restoration measure following the illegal felling of 1,100 mature trees in the protected Southern Ridge ("lungs of Delhi") by the Delhi Development Authority (DDA).

Andaman & Nicobar Underwater Guinness World Records (Swaraj Dweep)

- **Event Date**: May 2026 at **Swaraj Dweep** (formerly **Havelock Island**, South Andaman).
- **Two World Records**: Set by Andaman & Nicobar Administration to promote sustainable marine tourism: 1. *"Largest flag unfurled underwater"* (Indian National Tricolour). 2. *"Tallest human stack underwater"*.

Two New Ramsar Sites in Bihar (Gokul Jalashay & Udaipur Jheel)

- **Wetlands Tag**: Two prominent wetlands of Bihar were added to the global Ramsar List of Wetlands of International Importance: 1. **Gokul Jalashay** — located in **Buxar district**. 2. **Udaipur Jheel** — located in **West Champaran district** (renowned oxbow lake ecosystem along the Gandak floodplain).
- *(Note: Bihar's first Ramsar site was Kanwar Lake / Kabal Tal in Begusarai, designated in 2020).*

Bihar's First Natural Elephant Corridor

- **Notification**: Bihar Forest Department established the state's **first natural elephant corridor** to ensure secure migration pathways between Jharkhand and Bihar forests.
- **Encompassed Zones**: Covers the **Garhi forest area** of Jamui Forest Division, the **Charkapathar and Batiya forest areas** of Jhajha, and the **Madhwa sub-forest area** of Chakai Forest Division.

Asian Waterbird Census 2026 (Kosi Region)

- **Census Findings**: Conducted across the Kosi riverine wetlands in February 2026; recorded **4,982 waterbirds across 92 species**.
- **Rare Migratory Sighting**: Documented rare winter visitors including the **Baikal Teal** (*Anas formosa*, an elusive Siberian migratory duck) and the **Fulvous Whistling Teal**.

October 2026

High-Yield October Days & Exact Themes Board

Date	Day	Official Theme / Slogan	Exam Significance
2 Oct	**International Day of Non-Violence**	Mahatma Gandhi birth anniversary	Observed globally since 2007 (UNGA resolution).
5 Oct	**World Teachers' Day**	*"Standing with teachers: valuing teacher voices for education"*	Marks the 1966 ILO/UNESCO Recommendation.
7 Oct	**World Cotton Day**	*"Cotton for Good"*	Initiated by Cotton-4 nations (Benin, Burkina Faso, Chad, Mali).
9 Oct	**World Post Day**	*"150 years of enabling communication and empowering peoples"*	Marks the 1874 Treaty of Bern establishing Universal Postal Union (UPU, Bern, Switzerland).
10 Oct	**World Mental Health Day**	*"It is time to prioritize mental health in the workplace"*	Focus on workplace stress, burnout, and mental well-being.
11 Oct	**International Day of the Girl Child**	*"Girls' vision for the future"*	Established by UNGA in 2011; focus on adolescent girls' agency and rights.

Date	Day	Official Theme / Slogan	Exam Significance
12 Oct	**World Migratory Bird Day**	*"Protect Insects, Protect Birds"*	Highlights the precipitous decline of insects as critical nourishment for avian flyways.
13 Oct	**International Day for Disaster Risk Reduction**	*"Empowering the next generation for a resilient future"*	Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction (2015–2030) review.
15 Oct	**International Day of Rural Women**	*"Rural Women Cultivating Good Food for All"*	Acknowledges women's critical role in agrifood chains.
16 Oct	**World Food Day**	*"Right to foods for a better life and a better future"*	Commemorates founding of UN Food and Agriculture Organization (**FAO**, 1945, Rome).
20 Oct	**World Statistics Day**	*"Collaborative data for resilient governance"*	Celebrated every five years / statistical awareness.
24 Oct	**United Nations Day** & **World Polio Day**	*"A Campaign to Reach Every Child"* (Polio)	Marks entry into force of UN Charter (24 Oct 1945); Jonas Salk birth anniversary (Polio).

72nd National Wildlife Week | 2 to 8 October 2026

What happened The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC) and state wildlife departments observed the **72nd National Wildlife Week** from **2 to 8 October 2026**.

Core facts - **Core Theme:** *"Human–Wildlife Coexistence: Fostering Harmony for Sustainable Living"*. - **Initiatives:** Dedicated drives on community-led conflict mitigation, geo-fenced early-warning SMS alerts along elephant and leopard corridors, and school conservation pledges.

UN Biodiversity Summit (CBD COP16) | Cali, Colombia (October 2026)

What happened The **16th meeting of the Conference of the Parties to the Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD COP16)** convened in **Cali, Colombia**, under the overarching slogan ***"Peace with Nature"***.

Core facts - **Context:** The first substantive COP following the adoption of the historic **Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework (KMGBF)** at COP15 in 2022. - **Key Focus:** Reviewing updated National Biodiversity Strategies and Action Plans (**NBSAPs**) and tracking progress on the **"30x30 Target"** (protecting 30% of global land and marine areas by 2030). - **Core Stance of Developing Nations:** Demanded operationalisation of the multilateral mechanism for fair and equitable benefit-sharing from the use of **Digital Sequence Information (DSI)** on genetic resources.

Practice Zone — UPPCS Format

> **20 questions** for this sheet only — drill after you revise the months above. Formats match UPPCS 2024–25: multi-statement, Match List, NOT-matched, A/R, chronology. Full cross-topic index → Practice Zone hub.

Q1. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists.

List-I (Day)	List-II (2026 theme / fact)
A. World Wetlands Day	1. Water and Gender
B. World Water Day	2. Wetlands and traditional knowledge
C. International Day of Yoga	3. Inspired by Nature. For Climate. For Our Future.
D. World Environment Day	4. Yoga for Healthy Ageing

Row order is not the answer code.

A. 2 1 4 3 B. 2 4 1 3 C. 1 2 4 3 D. 2 1 3 4

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Match day ↔ 2026 theme (high-yield Environment CA format). **Ans: A.** Wetlands→2; Water→1; Yoga→4; WED→3. Trap: swapping Water Day theme with WED, or putting Yoga theme on Wetlands Day.

Q2. Which of the following pairs is/are **NOT** correctly matched?

1. Patna Bird Sanctuary — Aligarh
2. Shekha Jheel — Aligarh
3. Surha Tal (JP Narayan Bird Sanctuary) — Ballia

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 1 B. 1 and 2 C. 2 and 3 D. Only 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: UP Ramsar confused pairs — Etah / Aligarh / Ballia (2025-style NOT / location stems). **Ans: A.** Pair 1 is wrong — Patna Bird Sanctuary is in **Etah**, not Aligarh. Pairs 2 and 3 are correct. Trap: mixing the 2026 UP Ramsar trio.

Q3. With reference to Ramsar sites notified / announced in public coverage in 2026, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Surha Tal became India's 100th Ramsar site.
2. Glaw Lake in Arunachal Pradesh became India's 101st Ramsar site.
3. Glaw Lake is located inside Corbett Tiger Reserve.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: India's Ramsar count after Surha Tal and Glaw Lake. **Ans: A.** (1) and (2) true. (3) false — Glaw Lake is inside **Kamlang** Tiger Reserve, not Corbett. Trap: attaching a famous UP/Uttarakhand reserve name to Arunachal's first Ramsar.

Q4. With reference to the Solid Waste Management Rules, 2026, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The Rules were notified on 28 January 2026.
2. The Rules came into force on the same day, 28 January 2026.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: SWM Rules date trap — notified vs commence. **Ans: D.** Notified 28 January; **commencement 1 April 2026**. Trap: equating notification date with force date.

Q5. Which of the following pairs is/are **NOT** correctly matched?

1. Biodiversity Day (2026 theme) — Acting locally for global impact
2. International Tiger Day (2026 theme) — Yoga for Healthy Ageing
3. National Sports Day slogan (2026) — Khelega Bharat, Jeetega Bharat

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. 1 and 3 C. 2 and 3 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: NOT matched days — Constitution Day style from 2025 Q133. **Ans: A.** Pair 2 is wrong — Yoga for Healthy Ageing is **International Day of Yoga**, not Tiger Day. Tiger Day theme facts indigenous peoples / local communities. Pairs 1 and 3 are correct.

Q6. Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Surha Tal was announced as India's 100th Ramsar site in June 2026.

Reason (R): The 2026 World Environment Day theme was "Inspired by Nature. For Climate. For Our Future."

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) B. (A) is false, but (R) is true C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

▼ Show answer

A/R logic: A = Surha Tal 100th; R = WED theme — both true; R does not explain why Surha Tal is 100th. **Ans: A.** Timing overlap does not make the theme the cause of the 100th listing. Trap: choosing D because both floated on the same news day.

Q7. Which of the following Ramsar-related pairs is/are correctly matched for January 2026 public news?

1. Patna Bird Sanctuary — Etah, Uttar Pradesh
2. Chhari-Dhand — Kutch, Gujarat
3. Patna Bird Sanctuary — Patna, Bihar

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ Show answer

Logic: Chhari-Dhand + Patna pair (Jan Ramsar). **Ans: A.** Name "Patna" does **not** mean Bihar's capital — place fact is **Etah**. Trap designed exactly for that word confusion.

Q8. Which of the following pairs is/are **NOT** correctly matched?

1. International Women's Day 2026 — Rights. Justice. Action. For ALL Women and Girls
2. World Water Day 2026 — Our Power, Our Planet
3. Earth Day 2026 — Our Power, Our Planet

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. 1 and 3 C. 2 and 3 D. Only 1

▼ Show answer

Logic: Women's Day + Water Day themes (Match / NOT). **Ans: A.** Pair 2 is wrong — Water Day theme is **Water and Gender**. Earth Day is Our Power, Our Planet. Pair 1 is correct.

Q9. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists.

List-I (Day)	List-II (2026 theme)
A. World Health Day	1. Acting locally for global impact
B. Earth Day	2. Together for health. Stand with science
C. Biodiversity Day	3. Our Power, Our Planet
D. International Youth Day	4. Different Contexts, Common Aspirations

Row order is not the answer code.

A. 2 3 1 4 B. 2 1 3 4 C. 3 2 1 4 D. 2 3 4 1

▼ Show answer

Logic: Health / Earth Day April themes. **Ans: A.** Health→2; Earth→3; Biodiversity→1; Youth→4. Trap: swapping Earth and Biodiversity themes.

Q10. Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): Glaw Lake is Arunachal Pradesh's first Ramsar site.

Reason (R): Glaw Lake became India's 101st Ramsar site.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) B. (A) is false, but (R) is true C. (A) is true, but (R) is false D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

▼ **Show answer**

A/R logic: A = Glaw is Arunachal's first Ramsar; R = it is India's 101st — both true; R does not explain why it is Arunachal's first. **Ans: A.** Being 101st nation-wide does not by itself explain "first for Arunachal". Trap: D because both numbers feel linked.

Q11. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Surha Tal (Ballia) is India's 100th Ramsar site and UP's 13th in June 2026 coverage.
2. Shekha Jheel (Aligarh) is India's 99th Ramsar site and UP's 12th.
3. Patna Bird Sanctuary is in Aligarh district.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Mixed false-statement machine across months (final drill). **Ans: A.** (3) false — Patna Bird Sanctuary is in **Etah**. Final Ramsar confused-pair drill.

Q12. With reference to UP CAMP (June 2026), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Outlay about ₹2,741 crore.
2. World Bank support named in coverage.
3. It redesignated Surha Tal as a Ramsar site using that money line.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: UP CAMP clean air facts. **Ans: A.** Ramsar tag ≠ UP CAMP outlay.

Q13. With reference to World Environment Day, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It is led globally by UNEP.
2. Date is 5 June.
3. Date is 22 April.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: UNEP leads WED. **Ans: A.** 22 April = Earth Day.

Q14. With reference to Surha Tal ecology facts, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It lies on the Central Asian Flyway.
2. Coverage spoke of over 310 bird species.
3. It is in Etah district.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Surha Tal bird / flyway facts. **Ans: A.** Ballia.

Q15. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. India is highest in Asia for Ramsar sites in coverage.
2. India is third in the world after the UK and Mexico in coverage.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: India Ramsar global rank soft. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q16. With reference to SWM Rules, 2026, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. They replace the 2016 Rules.
2. They were notified on 28 January 2026.
3. They replace the Forest Rights Act, 2006.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: SWM Rules replace 2016. **Ans: A.** (3) wrong law.

Q17. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. World Elephant Day and International Youth Day both fall on 12 August.
2. National Sports Day slogan 2026: Khelega Bharat, Jeetega Bharat.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Elephant Day / Youth Day same date. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q18. With reference to International Tiger Day 2026, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Theme facts indigenous peoples and local communities at the heart.
2. Date is 29 July.
3. Theme is Yoga for Healthy Ageing.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Tiger Day theme July. **Ans: A.** Yoga is 21 June.

Q19. With reference to Glaw Lake, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. It is inside Kamlang Tiger Reserve.
2. It is Arunachal's first Ramsar site.
3. It is UP's 14th Ramsar site.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Glaw Lake Kamlang. **Ans: A.** UP count unchanged.

Q20. Which of the following statements is/are correct for UP's WED 2026 package?

1. Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam plantation campaign 2026 appeared in coverage.
2. UP CAMP clean-air project was launched the same day window.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam soft WED UP. **Ans: C.** Both true.